

The logo consists of a purple rounded square with the white text "SMS" inside. A large blue circle is positioned in the top right corner of the page.

SMS

SCHOOL MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

User Manual

Administrators · Teachers · Parents · Students

Admin

Teacher

Parent

Student

Version 2.0 · May 2026

School Management System

Decorative circles in various shades of blue and purple are located in the bottom left and bottom center of the page.

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1. Getting Started

System Overview

School Management System (SMS) is a web-based platform that centralises student records, academic tracking, fee management, and parent communication in one place. It runs on a local school server and is accessed from any device through a web browser — no installation required.

6 User Roles	10+ Modules	Any Browser Access	HTTPS Secure
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Accessing the System

Remote (recommended)	https://school.yourdomain.com — works anywhere with internet
On-site only	http://127.0.0.1:5000 — school network only

Logging In

Follow these steps to sign in:



Login flow — from browser to your dashboard

- 1 Open any web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari) on any device.
- 2 Navigate to **https://school.yourdomain.com** (or the school's local IP).
- 3 Click **Sign In** in the top-right corner of the homepage.
- 4 Enter your **Username** and **Password** — then click **Sign In**.
- 5 You are redirected to your role-specific dashboard automatically.

*** Tip:** Bookmark the URL for quick daily access. The system works on phones, tablets, and computers — no app to download.

User Roles

Every account has exactly one role. The role controls which pages and actions are available across the whole system.

Admin	Teacher	Accountant
Full access: all modules, user management, financial reports, system settings, admissions.	Attendance, grades, assignments, timetable, curriculum sharing with parents.	Finances, fees, payment plans, QuickBooks sync, read-only student records.
Frontdesk	Parent	Student
Student records, fee entry and payments, basic finance view.	Read-only portal: child's grades, attendance, fees, and announcements.	Read-only portal: own grades, attendance, assignments, announcements.
Viewer		
Read-only access to dashboard, students, grades, timetable, and finances.		

Navigation & Sidebar

The left sidebar is your main navigation panel. Here is a preview:

The **sidebar** shows links based on your role.

- Dashboard** — Stats and quick actions
- Students** — Full roster and profiles
- Attendance** — Daily entry by class
- Grades** — Grade book and report cards
- Finances** — Fees, payments, invoices
- Payroll** — Staff payroll (Admin only)

* **Tip:** Click the < button at the top to collapse the sidebar to icons only.

! Note: If a menu item is missing, your role may not have permission. Contact your Administrator to adjust access.

Session Timeout

For security, the system signs you out automatically after a period of inactivity.

- A warning overlay appears with a countdown before sign-out.
- Click **Stay Signed In** to reset the timer.
- Always click **Sign Out** when leaving your workstation.

* **Tip:** Move your mouse or press any key to reset the inactivity timer.

Remote Access

The system uses a secure **Cloudflare tunnel** to provide a permanent HTTPS web address accessible from anywhere in the world.

- Works on any device: phone, tablet, laptop, or desktop.
- No VPN, no app, no special software required.
- All connections are encrypted end-to-end (HTTPS).

! Note: The school server must be **powered on** and the SMS service must be running for the URL to respond. If the site is unavailable, check the server computer and restart the service if needed.

Admin Guide

Complete system management for administrators

1. Dashboard

The Admin dashboard is the first screen after login — a real-time snapshot of the school.

Active Students Total enrolled	Total Staff Active teachers	Fees Collected All-time income	Outstanding Fees still owed
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Feature	Description
Recent Activity	Latest system actions — grades entered, payments received, logins.
Quick Links	One-click shortcuts to common tasks: Add Student, Record Fee, etc.
Attendance Chart	Visual attendance summary across classes for the current week.
Overdue Fees	Students with unpaid fees highlighted at the top.

2. User Management

Go to **Users** in the sidebar to manage all system accounts.

Adding a New User

- 1 Click **Add User** (top-right of the Users page).
- 2 Enter full name, username, email address, and choose a role.
- 3 Set an initial password — the user should change it on first login.
- 4 For **Teacher** roles: set **Linked Record** to their Teachers table entry.
- 5 For **Parent / Student** roles: select the linked student record.

6 Click **Save**. The account is active immediately.

X Warning: Teacher accounts require a Linked Record. Without this link the teacher will see no students or classes after login. Set it in the Edit User form (Linked ID field).

*** Tip:** Parents can self-register at **/parent/register** using the Student ID and the parent email stored in the student record. No admin action needed.

3. Student Management

Go to **Students** to view, add, and manage all student records.

Adding a Student

- 1 Click **Add Student**.
- 2 The Student ID is auto-generated as a unique 10-digit number.
- 3 Fill in personal details: first/last name, date of birth, gender, address.
- 4 Assign a **Class** and set the **Enrollment Date**.
- 5 Enter parent/guardian name, email, and phone.
- 6 Click **Save**.

*** Tip:** Student IDs are unique 10-digit numbers — no duplicates possible. You can also type a custom ID if needed.

Student Detail Page

Click any student name to open their full profile:

- View grades, attendance, fees, and payment plans
- Download **Report Card PDF** (select term and year)
- Download **Fee Statement PDF** and **Progress Report PDF**
- Edit student info including date of birth and graduation date
- Upload a student photo

4. Staff Management

Go to **Staff** in the sidebar to manage teacher and staff records.

- 1 Click **Add Staff**.
- 2 Staff ID is auto-generated — or type a custom one.

3 Fill in name, job title, qualifications, hire date, and salary.

4 Click **Save**.

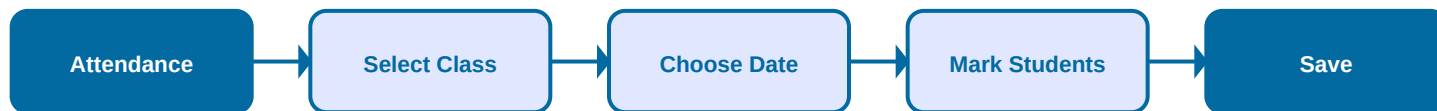
! Note: After adding a staff member, go to **Users** and create a login account — then link it to this staff record via the Linked ID field.

5. Classes & Subjects

Feature	Description
Add Class	Create a named class, assign a homeroom teacher, set room and capacity.
Add Subject	Add a subject linked to a class and teacher — used for grades and timetable.
Enroll	Assign students to classes from the Students page (Class field).

6. Attendance

Attendance is taken per class per day. Here is the full flow:



Attendance workflow — select class, date, mark each student, save

- Admin can view attendance for any class on any date.
- Teachers can only take attendance for their own classes.
- Attendance is shown per student on their detail page.
- Monthly attendance summary is included in the Progress Report PDF.

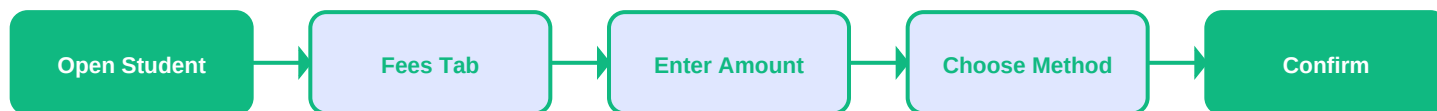
7. Grades & Assignments

Feature	Description
Enter Grades	Go to Grades → select class and subject → enter scores per student.
Exam Types	Supports: Quiz, Test, Midterm, Final, Assignment, Project, Participation.
Assignments	Create assignments with due dates and max scores per class.
Report Cards	Generate and download PDF report cards per student per term.
Progress Reports	Full academic report combining grades, attendance, and fee balance.

8. Finances & Fees

All financial activity is managed from the **Finances** section.

Recording a Fee Payment



Fee payment flow — open student → fees tab → enter amount → confirm

- 1 Open the student's profile page.
- 2 Click the **Fees** tab.
- 3 Click **Add Fee** or select an existing outstanding fee.
- 4 Enter the amount and choose the payment method.
- 5 Click **Confirm** — a receipt PDF is generated automatically.

* **Tip:** Student credits (overpayments) are stored and applied automatically to future fees.

9. Payment Plans

For students who cannot pay the full amount at once:

- 1 Open the student's profile → **Payment Plans** tab.
- 2 Click **Create Plan**.
- 3 Enter the total amount, description, and number of installments.
- 4 The system calculates the per-installment amount automatically.
- 5 Each installment can be paid independently as it comes due.

10. Walk-in Clients

Walk-in clients are external students or drop-in session participants who are not enrolled in a full programme.

- A 10-digit unique ID is generated automatically at check-in.
- Basic contact info and session notes are recorded.
- Fees can be charged per session.
- Walk-in records appear separately from regular enrolled students.

11. Announcements & Calendar

Feature	Description
Announcements	Post notices to all users or a specific role group (teachers, parents, etc.).
Calendar	Add school events, holidays, exam dates — visible to all logged-in users.
Notifications	Bell icon in the sidebar shows unread announcements for the current user.

12. Reports & PDFs

Feature	Description
Student List	Export the full student roster to CSV or PDF.
Attendance Report	Daily, weekly, or monthly attendance by class.
Fee Statement	Itemised payment history per student as a PDF.
Financial Summary	Total income, outstanding balance, payment method breakdown.
Report Card	Per-student academic report by term and year.
Progress Report	Comprehensive PDF: grades + attendance + fee balance.
Payroll Summary	Monthly payroll totals and individual payslips.

13. Payroll

The Payroll module manages staff salary, NIB contributions, and deductions. It is accessible only to Admins.

- Staff are synced automatically from the Teachers table.
- Set pay type (Weekly, Bi-Weekly, Monthly) and gross salary.
- Employee NIB (3.9%) and Employer NIB (5.9%) are calculated automatically.
- Add deductions per entity (loan, BICCU, school loan, etc.).
- Generate payslip PDFs and monthly payroll summary reports.

14. School Settings

Feature	Description
School Name / Logo	Appears on all PDF reports and the login page.
Language	Switch the system UI between English and Spanish.
Session Timeout	Set how long before inactive users are signed out.

Server Mode	LAN (local only) or Online (Cloudflare tunnel).
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Teacher Guide

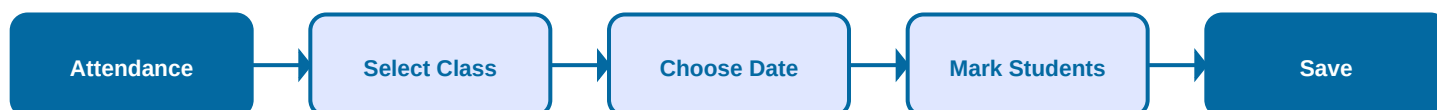
Attendance, grades, assignments and more

Teacher Dashboard

After login you see your personalised dashboard showing only your classes and students.



Taking Attendance



Attendance workflow for teachers

- 1 Click **Attendance** in the sidebar.
- 2 Select your **Class** from the dropdown.
- 3 The date defaults to today — change it if entering past records.
- 4 For each student, click **Present**, **Absent**, or **Late**.
- 5 Click **Save Attendance**. The records are saved instantly.

* **Tip:** You can edit a past attendance record by choosing an earlier date and re-saving. Only records for your own classes are accessible.

Entering Grades

- 1 Click **Grades** in the sidebar.
- 2 Select a **Class** and **Subject**.
- 3 Click **Add Grade** or click a student row to enter a score.
- 4 Choose the **Exam Type** (Quiz, Test, Midterm, Final, etc.).
- 5 Enter the **Score** and **Max Score** — the system calculates the percentage.
- 6 Click **Save**.

Feature	Description
Quiz	Short in-class quiz.
Test	Chapter or unit test.
Midterm	Mid-semester examination.
Final	End-of-semester examination.
Assignment	Graded homework or project.
Participation	Daily participation score.

Managing Assignments

- 1 Click **Assignments** in the sidebar.
- 2 Click **New Assignment**.
- 3 Enter title, description, select class and subject, set a due date and max score.
- 4 Click **Save**. Students see the assignment in their portal immediately.

*** Tip:** Students can view assignment details and due dates in their Student Portal.

Timetable

The timetable shows your weekly class schedule.

- Admins create timetable entries (class, subject, day, time, room).
- Teachers see their own schedule only.
- The weekly view shows all periods in a grid by day.

Announcements & Calendar

- Post announcements to your class or all users via **Announcements**.
- View school events in the **Calendar**.
- Unread notifications appear as a badge on the bell icon in the sidebar.

Parent Guide

Monitor your child's progress from anywhere

Registering Your Account

Parents self-register — no admin action is needed. You will need two pieces of information from the school:

Student ID	The 10-digit number assigned to your child (provided by the school).
Parent Email	The email address the school has on file for your family.

- 1 Go to the school's website and click **Sign In**.
- 2 On the login page click "**Register your account here**".
- 3 Enter your child's **Student ID** and your **Parent Email**.
- 4 Choose a username and password for your new account.
- 5 Click **Register**. You are logged in immediately.

* **Tip:** If registration fails, contact the school to confirm the Student ID and the email address they have on file for you.

Parent Portal Overview

After login you see your child's summary dashboard:

Feature	Description
Grades	All recorded grades by subject and exam type.
Attendance	Daily attendance record — present, absent, or late.
Fees	Current balance, payment history, and due dates.
Fee Statement	Download a PDF itemised fee statement.

Announcements	School and class notices posted by staff.
Assignments	List of upcoming and past assignments with due dates.

! Note: The Parent Portal is **read-only**. You cannot edit student information or make payments directly through the portal. Contact the school for changes.

Viewing Fees & Payment Status

- The **Fees** section shows all charges with their due dates and paid amounts.
- Outstanding balances are highlighted in red.
- Click **Download Fee Statement** for a printable PDF receipt history.

Student Guide

Your academic record at a glance

Student Portal Overview

The student portal is a read-only view of your own academic record. Your school will give you a username and password to log in.

Feature	Description
Grades	All your grades by subject, exam type, and term.
Attendance	Your attendance record — present, absent, late.
Assignments	Upcoming and past assignments with due dates.
Fees	Your fee balance and payment status.
Announcements	School-wide and class-specific notices.

Viewing Your Grades

- Click **Grades** in the sidebar to see all recorded scores.
- Grades are sorted by subject, then by date.
- Your average score per subject is shown at the top.
- Percentage and letter grade are calculated automatically.

Attendance Record

- Click **Attendance** to see your daily record.
- Days marked **Absent** or **Late** are highlighted.
- Your overall attendance percentage is shown at the top.

Assignments

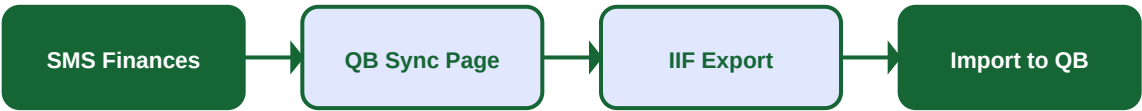
- All assignments posted by your teachers appear here.
- Upcoming due dates are shown — plan ahead!
- Past assignments are archived and still viewable.

QuickBooks & Web Connector

Sync financial data with QuickBooks Desktop

Sync Overview

SMS can export financial transactions to QuickBooks Desktop in two ways:



Manual IIF export flow — from SMS to QuickBooks

Manual Export	Download an IIF file from QB Sync → import it into QuickBooks manually.
Web Connector	Automatic sync via the QuickBooks Web Connector app (recommended).

Manual IIF Export

- 1 Go to **QB Sync** in the sidebar.
- 2 Select the date range for the export.
- 3 Click **Download IIF**.
- 4 In QuickBooks Desktop: File → Utilities → Import → IIF Files.
- 5 Select the downloaded file and click **Open**.

Web Connector Auto-Sync Setup

- 1 Download the **QWC file** from the QB Sync page in SMS.
- 2 Open QuickBooks Web Connector (installed with QuickBooks Desktop).

- 3 Click **Add an Application** and select the QWC file.
- 4 Set a **password** when prompted — save this.
- 5 Set the **sync interval** (e.g. every 60 minutes).
- 6 Click **Update Selected** to run the first sync.

*** Tip:** The Web Connector must be running on the same computer as QuickBooks Desktop. It can run minimised in the background.

Required QuickBooks Accounts

Feature	Description
Tuition Income	Income account for regular tuition fee payments.
Other School Income	Income account for miscellaneous school fees.
Undeposited Funds	Asset account used as the payment clearing account.
Accounts Receivable	Asset account for outstanding student fee balances.

! Note: The account names in QuickBooks must match exactly what SMS expects. If the import fails, check that these accounts exist and are not renamed.

Troubleshooting

Feature	Description
IIF import fails	Check that all required QB accounts exist with exact names.
Web Connector error	Confirm the SMS server is running and the QB Sync password is correct.
Duplicate transactions	Do not import the same IIF file twice — use the date range filter.
Wrong amounts	Verify the date range matches the transactions you expect to sync.